

Ido Benbaji Elhadad

ibenbaji@mit.edu

<https://idobenbaji.github.io>

Employment

2026- **University of Tübingen**
Post-doctoral researcher, DFG funded project SFB1718 on *The Common Ground*
PIs: Michael Franke & Todd Snider

Education

DEGREE STUDIES

2019-2026 **Massachusetts Institute of Technology**
Ph.D in Linguistics
Thesis: “*Some Constraints on Possible Worlds in Semantics and Pragmatics*”

2015-2018 **The Hebrew University of Jerusalem**
BA in Linguistics and History
Summa cum laude

NON-DEGREE STUDIES

2018, 2022 **The Crete Summer School of Linguistics**
The Department of Philology, University of Crete

2016 **University College Dublin**
Erasmus+ student exchange program

Publications

JOURNAL ARTICLES (PEER-REVIEWED)

ACCEPTED **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** “[Reconstruction, bare quantification, and the fourth reading.](#)” *Semantics of Natural Languages*.

ACCEPTED
(WITH RE-
VISIONS) **Benbaji-Elhadad, I. & O. Doron.** “[The Varieties of Relevance.](#)” *Journal of Semantics*.

R&R **Benbaji-Elhadad, I. & D. Pesetsky.** “[Ingredients of Ellipsis: E-extension and the Uniformity of Silence.](#)” *Linguistic Inquiry*.

2026 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** “[A hitherto unnoticed sloppy reading of proper names.](#)” *Snippets*.

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS (ABSTRACT PEER-REVIEWED)

- 2026 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** & O. Doron. “Saving FACE: Fragment answers, copy theory, and radical trace conversion.” *Proceedings of the North Eastern Linguistic Society (NELS)* 56.
- 2026 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** “A challenge to unified accounts of non-canonical belief reports.” *Proceedings of the North Eastern Linguistic Society (NELS)* 56.
- 2026 Feldcamp, Z. & **I. Benbaji-Elhadad**. “A well-formedness condition on alternative generation.” *Proceedings of the West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL)* 43.
- 2024 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** & J. Wehbe. “On the semantics of unit fractions.” *Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB)* 28: 131-149.
- 2024 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** & O. Doron. “How is presupposition accommodation constrained, again?” *Proceedings of the 24th Amsterdam Colloquium*: 22-28.
- 2023 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** “Preliminaries for a substitution theory of *de re*.” *Proceedings of Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 33: 358-378.
- 2023 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.**, O. Doron & A. Hénot-Mortier. “Distinguishing levels of morphological derivation in word-embedding models.” *Proceedings of the North Eastern Linguistic Society (NELS)* 53: 63-76.
- 2023 **Benbaji, I.** & O. Doron. “Adversative *only* is only *only*.” *Proceedings of Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB)* 27: 64-80.
- 2022 **Benbaji, I.** “Focus particles in verb-echo answers: An argument for Argument Ellipsis.” *Proceedings of the North Eastern Linguistic Society (NELS)* 52: 67-80.
- 2022 **Benbaji, I.**, O. Doron & A. Hénot-Mortier. “Word-embeddings distinguish denominal and root-derived verbs in Semitic.” *Proceedings of End-to-End Compositional Models of Vector-Based Semantics*: 35-49.
- 2021 **Benbaji, I.** “Restricting the fourth reading.” *Proceedings of Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 31: 221-240.
- 2021 **Benbaji, I.**, O. Doron & R. Wang. “A new diagnostic for antonym decomposition.” *Proceedings of the North Eastern Linguistic Society (NELS)* 51: 51-64.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** & O. Doron. “Hey, wait a minute! If scalar implicatures are presupposed, why do they fail the “Hey, wait a minute!” test?” In *A Festschrift for Danny Fox*, eds. Márta Abrusán, Luka Crnić, Colin Davis, Roni Katzir, Yasutada Sudo, Shoichi Takahashi, and Tue Trinh, 71-80. Cambridge, MA: MITWPL.

Presentations

REFEREED BY ABSTRACT

- 2025 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** “Specific-opaque readings as belief revision/replacement.” *North Eastern Linguistic Society (NELS)* 56. New York University. 17-19 October, 2025.

- 2025 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** & O. Doron. “Saving FACE: Fragment answers, copy theory, and radical trace conversion.” *North Eastern Linguistic Society (NELS)* 56. New York University. 17-19 October, 2025.
- 2024 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** “Worlds, times and the fate of Ontological Symmetry.” *Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB)* 29. C.U.M.O., Noto, Sicily. 17-20 September, 2024.
- 2024 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** “Specific-opaque readings and the temporal interpretation of NPs.” *West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL)* 42. UC Berkeley. 12-14 April, 2024.
- 2024 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** & O. Doron. “Relevance as a dynamic constraint.” *West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL)* 42. University of California, Berkeley. 12-14 April, 2024.
- 2023 **Benbaji-Elhadad, I.** & D. Pesetsky. “E-extension and the uniformity of silence.” *North Eastern Linguistic Society (NELS)* 53. Georg-August-Universität, Göttingen. 12-14 January, 2023.
- 2022 **Benbaji, I.** “Proper names and the syntax-semantics of coercion.” *The 3rd Context, Cognition & Communication Conference*. University of Warsaw. 19-22 September, 2022.
- 2022 **Benbaji, I.**, F.H. Kobayashi & Y. Sinha. “The logic of Hindi co-compounds.” *Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB)* 27. Charles University, Prague. 14-16 September, 2022.
- 2020 **Benbaji, I.**, O. Doron & R. Wang. “Hebrew reduplication as a diagnostic for antonym decomposition.” *Sinn und Bedeutung (SuB)* 25. University College London & Queen Mary University of London. 3-9 September, 2020.
- 2018 **Benbaji, I.** “A context sensitive semantics for proper names.” *RALFe 2018—Rencontres d’Automne de Linguistique Formelle*. Université Paris 8/CNRS. 6-7 December, 2018.
- 2018 **Benbaji, I.** “A context sensitive semantics for proper names.” *Philosophy of Language & Mind Master Class with Prof. Angelika Kratzer*. Universität Salzburg. 23 October, 2018.

INVITED TALKS

- 2024 **Benbaji, I.** “Missing temporariness implicatures and their consequence for the theory of alternatives (Joint work with Zachary Feldcamp).” *LINGUAE Seminar*. Institut Jean Nicod. 26 September, 2024.
- 2024 **Benbaji, I.** “Specific-opaque readings and the temporal interpretation of noun phrases.” *Departmental Colloquium*. Tel Aviv University. 22 February, 2024.
- 2023 **Benbaji, I.** “Property-coerced names are not metaphors: the case for coercion operators for proper names.” *Linguistic speaker series*. Northeastern University. 16 February, 2023.

Awards, Fellowships & Grants

- 2022-2023 **Noam Chomsky Graduate Fellowship**
Funding award for outstanding progress in the MIT linguistics PhD program
- 2020 **Best Student Presentation Award**
Awarded at *Sinn und Bedeutung* 25 for a joint talk with Omri Doron & Ruolan Wang
- 2018-2019 **Mandel School for Advanced Studies in the Humanities Honors Program**
Funding award for outstanding graduate students in the humanities, the Hebrew University

- 2018-2019 **The Hebrew University and Tel Aviv University Joint Scholarship**
Funding award for outstanding graduate students in linguistics
- 2018 **The Gad Frenkel Prize for Excellent B.A. Papers in Linguistics**
Awarded by The Linguistics Department of The Hebrew University of Jerusalem
- 2016 **The Rector's Award**
The Hebrew University of Jerusalem
- 2016 **The Dean's Award**
The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

Teaching

- Fall 2022 **Teaching Assistant:** *Language and its structure II: Syntax* (Undergraduate)
Instructors: Sabine Iatridou & Will Oxford
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
- Summer 2022 **Teaching Assistant:** *Introduction to Semantics* (Undergraduate)
Instructor: Cleo Condoravdi
The Fourth Crete Summer School of Linguistics
- Spring 2022 **Teaching Assistant:** *Advanced Semantics* (Graduate)
Instructors: Amy Rose Deal & Martin Hackl
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
- Spring 2021 **Teaching Assistant:** *Introduction to Linguistics* (Undergraduate)
Instructor: Norvin Richards
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
- Spring 2019 **Teaching Assistant:** *Issues in Semantics* (Undergraduate)
Instructor: Todd Snider
The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

Non-academic employment and experience

EMPLOYMENT

- 2014-2018 **Chief Political Correspondent**
GLZ Radio, Israel
- 2015-2016 **Moderator, weekly evening news broadcast**
GLZ Radio, Israel
- 2012-2014 **West Bank Correspondent**
GLZ Radio, Israel

NON-DEGREE STUDIES

- January 2017 **International Visitor Leadership Program (IVLP)**
The United States Department of State, Washington DC

PUBLIC WRITING

- 2025 Panievsky, A. & I. Benbaji. "[Eyes wide shut: When the war on the media met the war in Gaza.](#)" *Molad center for the renewal of Israeli democracy*. (Hebrew report; see English executive summary [here](#), and English media coverage below.)

- ❖ CNN: “Global outrage has grown after two years of bombardment in Gaza. In Israel, it is a different story.”
- ❖ Haaretz: “When It Comes to Covering the Gaza War, ‘Israeli Media Is Like a Doctor Hiding the Patient’s Condition.’”

2024 **Benbaji, I.** “Netanyahu abandoned, Channel 12 normalized.” *TheMarker* (Hebrew).
 2024 **Benbaji, I.** “As the masses protested, Master Chef was aired again.” *Walla!* (Hebrew).
 2019 **Benbaji, I.** “Lieberman had no choice.” *Haaretz* (Hebrew).
 2017 **Benbaji, I.** “Silent now, the world will pay later.” *Haaretz* (Hebrew).